MY JAVASCRIPT ADVENTURE

A 12-Step Coding Journey

Learn to make the computer listen, think, and play — one step at a time!

CODER'S NAME: _____

DATE I STARTED: _____

MY CODING BUDDY: _____

HOW THIS WORKS

There are 6 phases, each with 2 steps. Every step has a goal, things to learn, and a fun challenge to finish. Go at your own pace — move to the next step whenever you feel ready, not on a schedule. Tick the box when a step is done, and don't be afraid of red error messages — they just mean the computer is confused, not you!

PHASE 1 — TALKING TO THE COMPUTER

Goal: discover that code is just YOU giving instructions.

- [ ] **STEP 1 — Say Hello**
  Learn: console.log(), alert(), what a 'command' is
  Do: Make the computer say your name, your age, and something silly you choose.
  Challenge: Get the computer to say 5 different funny things using console.log().

- [ ] **STEP 2 — Boxes for Stuff**
  Learn: Variables (let, const) as labeled boxes that hold information
  Do: Store your name, favorite color, and favorite animal in variables, then print them.
  Challenge: Create a variable for your age and print a sentence that includes it.

PHASE 2 — MAKING DECISIONS

Goal: learn that computers can choose what to do next.

- [ ] **STEP 3 — If This, Then That**
  Learn: if / else statements, comparing numbers
  Do: Write code that checks if a number is bigger than 5 and reacts differently.
  Challenge: Build a mini game: if you guess the secret number right, it celebrates!

- [ ] **STEP 4 — Would You Rather?**
  Learn: Comparison operators (>, <, ===), prompt()
  Do: Ask a question with prompt() and respond differently based on the answer.
  Challenge: Make a 3-question 'Would You Rather' quiz with fun replies.

PHASE 3 — DOING THINGS AGAIN AND AGAIN

Goal: discover that computers love repeating boring things.

- [ ] **STEP 5 — Loop-the-Loop**
  Learn: for loops
  Do: Print your name 10 times, then build a countdown from 10 to 1.
  Challenge: Make a loop that prints every even number from 1 to 20.

- [ ] **STEP 6 — Keep Asking**
  Learn: while loops
  Do: Build a 'guess the secret number' game that keeps asking until correct.
  Challenge: Add a counter that tells the player how many guesses they used.

PHASE 4 — MAKING THINGS MOVE

Goal: connect code to things you can actually see on screen.

- [ ] **STEP 7 — Meet the Webpage**
  Learn: Basic HTML, changing a box's color with a button click
  Do: Make a button that changes a colored box every time it's clicked.
  Challenge: Cycle through 4 different colors when the button is clicked.

- [ ] **STEP 8 — Click Counter**
  Learn: Connecting JavaScript to buttons and text on a webpage
  Do: Build a webpage that counts how many times a button has been clicked.
  Challenge: Add a 'reset' button that sets the counter back to zero.

PHASE 5 — ORGANIZING YOUR CODE

Goal: learn that functions are like recipes you can reuse.

- [ ] **STEP 9 — Recipe Machines**
  Learn: Functions — writing and calling them
  Do: Write a sayHello(name) function and an addNumbers(a, b) function.
  Challenge: Write a function that tells you if a number is odd or even.

- [ ] **STEP 10 — Recipes + Repeating**
  Learn: Using functions inside loops
  Do: Build a times-table generator using a function and a loop together.
  Challenge: Let the player choose which times table to generate.

PHASE 6 — MY FIRST REAL PROJECT

Goal: build something real, from scratch, and show it off.

- [ ] **STEP 11 — Plan & Build**
  Learn: Putting everything together
  Do: Choose a project: Rock-Paper-Scissors, a quiz, or a choose-your-own-adventure story.
  Challenge: Get the core game working, even if it's not pretty yet.

- [ ] **STEP 12 — Finish & Show Off**
  Learn: Polishing and presenting your work
  Do: Add your own personal touch — your name, favorite colors, or sounds.
  Challenge: Show your project to someone and explain how it works!

TIPS FOR THIS ADVENTURE

- Errors in red text are clues, not failures — read them like a detective.
- Say your code out loud before you type it. If you can explain it, you can write it.
- A variable is a labeled box. A function is a recipe. A loop is 'do this until I say stop.'
- Keep a 'Brag Folder' — save every project, even the messy ones, to see how far you've come.
- It's okay to peek at the answer sometimes — the goal is understanding, not memorizing.
- Take breaks. 30 minutes of focused fun beats 2 hours of frustration.

MY PROGRESS TRACKER

Step	Done?	What I Built	How I Felt (1-5)
STEP 1	■		
STEP 2	■		
STEP 3	■		
STEP 4	■		
STEP 5	■		
STEP 6	■		
STEP 7	■		
STEP 8	■		
STEP 9	■		
STEP 10	■		
STEP 11	■		
STEP 12	■		

When you finish all 12 steps, you won't just know JavaScript — you'll know how to break big problems into small steps, and that's a superpower for anything you build next.